fully examined through available information and database available with MDRA. In the second stage, verification and audits of the participating B-schools were conducted by MDRA researchers to ensure accuracy and correctness of the data submitted. Nearly 15 per cent of the participating B-schools were physically visited by the research team to verify the authenticity of the data. In the past 12 years, MDRA researchers have visited close to 700 campuses to verify the various information provided by participating institutes. After cross-checking the data with the original documents/ infrastructure, some irregularities were corrected.

The five key parameters of evaluation were Learning Experience, Living Experience, Selection Process, Placement Performance and Future Orientation.

PARAMETERS AND WEIGHTAGE

Learning experience: **250**
Placement performance: **250**
Future orientation: **200**
Selection process, governance and establishment: **150**
Living experience: **150**
Total: **1,000**

The scores of these parameters were then summed up to get the total objective score of each institute. The final rank was assigned to B-schools based on objective data after various levels of cross-validation through multiple sources and physical audits.

EXECUTIVE MANAGEMENT COURSE RANKING

It has been prepared based on objective data and perception survey of management programmes (12–18 months) for working executives. These are full-time, in-classroom programmes with tough admission criteria such as work experience and entrance test scores that require rigorous commitment from the students. The objective parameters cover aspects such as admission attractiveness, pedagogy and infrastructure, career growth, return on investment and brand appeal. In the second year of this particular ranking, nine institutes submitted the objective data of their executive management programme within the timeline. However, some institutes, which did not submit their data, were ranked based on publicly available data. Simultaneously, a perception survey was conducted among various stakeholders, including faculty, students, recruiters and alumni. In total, 281 relevant respondents including 100 students, 70 faculty, 57 alumni and 54 recruiters were surveyed for the perception survey. Final scores were given by adding both the objective and perception scores in equal proportion.

EDTECH RANKING

This was done based on objective data collected from secondary sources. Edtech platforms offering MBA/ PGDM courses in India in association with an Indian or a global institute or university, were ranked. Parameters such as cost of education, number of offerings (choices), admission criteria, scholarship opportunity, reputation of university/ college that is awarding the degree or diploma, learning exposure, learning platforms, and placement support were assessed to rank these Edtechs offering management courses. These factors were meticulously evaluated, and the final scores were derived based on the objective data gathered.

EXECUTIVE PROGRAMME RANKING

Indian B-schools offer a diverse array of executive programmes, catering to a broad spectrum of participants—from individuals with no prior experience to senior management professionals with over 15 years of relevant expertise. These programmes differ in focus, ranging from general management to specialised or industry-specific themes. They also vary in terms of curriculum, pedagogy, delivery methods (ranging from hybrid models to direct-to-device formats), faculty quality, alumni benefits, and programme fees. Notably, these programmes do not confer an MBA or equivalent degree/diploma. Only general management programmes from top institutes that are rigorously operated and have been there for some time were evaluated for this ranking. These programmes were ranked based on the objective data collected through secondary research. Parameters such as programme fees, the institute's reputation, course sustainability, number of interactions per week, eligibility criteria, number of online/ offline classes and pedagogy were considered.

A large team comprising researchers, statisticians, econometricians and analysts worked on this project from February 2024 to August 2024. The MDRA core team, led by Executive Director Abhishek Agrawal, comprised Project Director Abnish Jha, Deputy Research Manager Vaibhav Gupta, Assistant Research Executive Abhay Pratap Singh and Assistant Manager EDP Manveer Singh.